

ple data types. They may become complicated if you store complex data structures.

Relational database: The relational model is the most commonly used database in the present scenario. MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server and Oracle are best examples of relational databases. In a relational database, tables are used to represent some interlinked objects. In the relational model, databases are arranged for maintaining integrity.

11.2 Database connection:

A database connection is a system that establishes a connection between the client and database software. This connection helps in sending commands and getting answers in a result set. Basically, there are two sources of database connection - data source and driver manager.

PHP MySQL database connection:

In the following code fragment, you can see `mysql_connect()` connects to the MySQL database server.

```
$con=mysql_connect("localhost", "root", "password");
    If (! $con )
        Die( "Couldn't connect database" );
```

Persistent database connection is also a connection method designed to represent some regular connections. A persistent connection is often used as a substitute for a non persistent connection. A non-persistent connection may bring change in the script efficiency but not in its performance.

You can also establish a database connection by using PEAR DB:

```
<?php
require_once 'DB.php';
$dbh =
DB::connect("mysql://test@localhost/test");
if (DB::isError($dbh)) {
    print "Connect failed!\n";
    print "Error message: " . $dbh->getMessage() .
"\n";
```